

hys sonnes and his brethren, euen cyghene. And Hasabiah, and with him Ilat of the children of Merari, with his brethren and they sonnes, twentie. And of the Rechinims, who David & the Princes gaue to mynister vnto the Leuites, two hundred & twenty of Rechinims, which all were named by name.

And euen there at the water, besyde Abana, I proclaimed a fast, that we myghte humble oure selues before oure God, and seke of him a ryghte waye for vs, and for oure children and for all oure substance. For I was named to requyre of the kynge, souldiers & horsen, to helpe vs agaynst the enemy in the waye: but we sayd vnto the kynge: The hande of oure God is vpon all the that seke hym in goodnes, and (hys domynion) hys violence and wrath is agaynst all them that forsake hym. So we fasted, and besoughte oure God for this, and he hearde vs.

And I toke out twelue of the chiefe preastes, Sarabiah and Hasabiah, and ten of their brethren with them, and weyed them syluer and golde, & vessels that were appoynted for the house of oure God, which the kynge and his counsellors and his Lordes, and all Israell that were there at hande, had geuen together. And I weyed vnto their hande six hundred & syftie talentes of syluer, & in syluer vessel an hundred talentes, & in golde an hundred talentes: twentie basens of golde of a thousande peces, and two costly ornaments of good brasse, as cleare as golde: and I sayde vnto them: Ye are consecrate vnto the Lorde, lyke as the vessels are holy also, and the golde and syluer are geue of a good wyll vnto the

Lorde God of youre fathers. Watch ye, and kepe it: for ye shall weye it downe before the chiefe preastes and Leuites, and auncient fathers of Israell at Ierusalem in the treasuries of the house of the Lorde. Then toke I preastes and Leuites that weyed syluer and golde and vessel, to bringe it to Ierusalem, vnto the house of oure God. And we brake vp, from the water of Abana on the tweluen daye of the fyrst moneth, to go vnto Ierusalem: and the hande of oure God was vpon vs, and deliuered vs from the hande of the enemy, and of such as layde wayte for vs by the waye.

And we came to Ierusalem, and abode there thre dayes. But on the fourth daye was the syluer and golde and vessel weyed in the house of oure God, by the hande of Meremoth the sonne of Uziah the preaste, and with hym was Eleazar the sonne of Phinehes, & with them was Josabab the sonne of Iesua, and Noadiah the sonne of Benoi the Leuites. According to the nombere and weyght of euery one, was the weyght all wyrtten vp at the same tyme.

And the children of the captiuite, which were come out of prison, offered burnt offe-

rynges vnto the God of Israell: twelue bullockes for all Israell, syxe and nyntye rammes, seuen and seuentie lambes, twelue he-goates for a synofferynge, all to the burnt-offerynge of the Lorde. And they deliuered the kynges commission vnto the kynges officers, & to the capitaynes that were on thys syde the water. And they promoted the people and the house of God.

The ix. Chapter.

Esdas complayneth on the people that had turned them selues from God, and married with the gentiles.



When these thynges were done, the rulers came to me, and sayde: The people of Israell, and the preastes, and Leuites are not separated from the people of the landes (as touchynge their abhominacions) namely of the Cananites, Hethites, Pherezites, Jebusites, Ammonites, Moabites, Egyptians, and Amozites. For they haue taken the daughters of the same to the selues, and to their sonnes, and the holy sede is mixte with the nations in the lande: and the hande of the princes & rulers hath bene principall in this trespass.

And when I hearde this saying, I rete my clothes and my rayment, and I luckte of the heer of my heade, and of my beerd, and late mourninge. And there resorted vnto me all such as feared the wordes of the Lorde God of Israell, because of the trasgression of the people of the captiuite. And I late mourninge vntill the euenynge sacrifice. And aboute the euenynge sacrifice, I rose vp from my benynges, and rente my clothes and my rayment, and fell vpon my knees, and spred out my handes vnto the Lorde my God, and sayde.

O my God, I am ashamed, and darre not lyfte vp myne eyes vnto my God: for oure wyckednesses are growne ouer oure heed, and oure trespase is waxen greete vnto the heauen. Sence the tyme of oure fathers haue we bene in greete trespase vnto this daye, and because of oure wyckednesses haue we and oure kynges bene deliuered into the hande of the kynges of the nacionys, into the swerde, into captiuite, into shame, and into confusio of face, as it is to se this daye.

And now is there a lytle & sodayne graciousnes come from the Lorde oure God, in causynge some of vs to escape, and that he maye geue vs a nape in hys holy place, and that oure God maye lyghte oure eyes, and geue vs a lytle lyfe to take bryth in oure bondage. For we are bondme, & oure God hath not forsaken vs in oure bondage, and hath enclined mercy vnto vs in the syghte of the kynges of Persia, to geue vs lyfe, to lett vs the house

the house of oure God, and to redresse the desolacion therof, and to geue vs a wall in Iuda and Ierusalem.

And now, O oure God, what shall we saye after this: for we haue forsaken thy commaundementes, whych thou hast commaunded by thy seruantes the prophetes, sayeng: The lande vnto which ye go to possesse, it is an vncleane land, because of the fylthynes of the people of the landes, whych with theyr abhominacions haue made it full of vncleanness on euery syde. Therefore shall ye not geue poure daughters vnto their sonnes, and their daughters shall ye not take vnto poure sonnes, ner seke their peace & welth for euer, that ye maye be strong, & enioye the good in the land, & ye & poure chyldren maye haue the inheritaunce of it for euermore.

And after that all these thynges are come vpon vs (because of oure euell dedes & greete trespasses) thou oure God hast thrust downe oure wickednesses, & hast geue vs a deliuerance, (as it is cometo passe this daye.)

And yf we turne backe agayne, to let go thy commaundementes, and make contracte with the people of these abhominacions, wilt thou not then be wroth at vs (as not without cause) tyl we be utterly consumed, so that no thyng remayne, and tyll there be no deliuerance? O Lord God of Israell, part ryghteous, for we remayne yet escaped, at it is to se this daye. Behold also, in thy presence are we in oure trespasses, & because of it maye we not stande before the.

The x. Chapter.

The people repente, and tume, and put awaye theyr straunge wyues.



And when Esd. 2. prayed after this maner, & knowleged, wepte, & laye before the house of God, there resorted vnto him out of Israell a very greete congregacyon of men and women, and chyldren: & the people wepte very sore. And Sechania the sonne of Jehiel one of the children of Elam, answered, and sayde vnto Esd. 2. We haue trespassed agaynst oure God, and haue taken straunge wyues of the people of the land. Now there is hope yet in Israell concerning this thyng: for now we wyll make a couenaunt with oure God, and put awaye all the wyues (and such as are borne of them) accordinge to the counsell of the Lorde, and we wyll be in the feare of the commaundementes of oure God, that we maye do accordinge to the lawe. Get the vp, for thys matter belongeth vnto the. we also wyll be with the, be of good conforte therefore, and do it.

Then rose Esd. 2. and toke an oth of the chiefe preastes and Leuites, and of all Israell, that they shulde do accordinge to thys worde: & they sware. And Esd. 2. stode vp

from before the house of God, and went into the chamber of Iohanan the sonne of Eliafib. And when he came thither, he dyd eate no bred, nor dranke water: for he mourned because of the trasgression of the people that had bene in captiuite.

And they caused a proclamacyon to go thorow out Iuda and Ierusalem, vnto all the chyldren which had bene in captiuite, & they shuld geather the selues togeather vnto Ierusalem. And that whosoever came not wyth in thre dayes accordinge to the deuys of the rulers and Elders, all hys substance shulde be forfett, and he shulde be put out fro the congregacyon of the captiue.

Then all the men of Iuda and Ben Jamin geathered them selues togeather vnto Ierusalem wythin thre dayes, euen the twentie daye of the nyenth moneth: and all the people sat in the strete before the house of God, and trembled because of thys matter, & for the rayne. And Esd. 2. the preaste stode vp, and sayde vnto them. Ye haue trasgressed, and haue taken straunge wyues, to make a trespase of Israell yet more: confesse now therefore vnto the Lorde God of youre fathers, and do hys pleasure, and separate poure selues from the people of the land, & from the straunge wyues. And all the congregacyon answered, and sayd with a loude voyce: It shalbe so, and we will do as thou hast sayde.

But the people are many, and it is a rayne whether, and the people are to saynt to tarve without in the strete, nerther is this a worcke of one daye or two, for we haue offended very sore in this thyng. Let oure rulers stand therefore in all the congregacyon, and lett all them whych haue taken straunge wyues in oure cyties come at the tyme appoynted, and let the Elders of euery cytie and they Judges be with them, tyll they haue turned the wrath of oure God awaye from vs concerning this matter.

Then were appoynted Jonathan the sonne of Ababel, and Jahalia the sonne of Thakua ouer thys matter: And Josullani and Sabatha the Leuites helped them. And the chyldren of the captiuite dyd euen so. And Esd. 2. the preaste, and the auncient heades thorow the house of theyr fathers, all men of great fame, separated the selues, and sat them downe on the fyrst daye of the tenth moneth, to examen the matter. And vntill the fyrst daye of the fyrst moneth they were synnyng the busyness wyth all the men that had taken straunge wyues.

And amonge the chyldren of the preastes there were men founde that had taken straunge wyues, namely amonge the chyldren of Iesua the sonne of Josedec and of hys brethren, Maliah, and Eliezer, Jariab and Gedalia, and they gaue theyr handes there